2013 Honda Civic HF

$8,000 · 140,000 miles · Private seller · Palmdale, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Craigslist

Listing: https://www.craigslist.org/view/d/palmdale-2013-honda-civic-hf-not-hybrid/wTvivNFGaXfD9iZcTfs4uh

Report generated October 27, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 4 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$8,980	**$471**	**Good**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	4/5 · 0 recalls · 319 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$8,000.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$740.00
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$52.00
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$8,980.00
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$3,980.00
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$79.75
Total interest over the loan	$805.06
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$79.75
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 33 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$143.94
Maintenance & repair reserve	$95.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$16.83
Total per month	$470.52

Running costs without the loan: **$391/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$14,095** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Good (4/5)

The 2013 Civic (1.8L R18, 5-speed auto) is one of the more reliable used compacts; 2013 fixed most of the 2012 redesign complaints. At 140k it needs its maintenance history checked.

NHTSA data for this model year: 0 recalls · 319 owner complaints (29 involving a crash). Most complaints: Air Bags (114), Service Brakes (39), Electrical System (39), Steering (38), Unknown Or Other (29), Structure (23).

Known issues for this model

• A/C compressor / condenser failures

• Engine mount wear (vibration at idle)

• Valve adjustment due ~100-110k if never done

• Takata airbag recall - confirm completed

Check on this car before buying

• Title in seller's name and matches VIN

• Run VIN for recalls (Takata)

• A/C cold at idle in heat

• Vibration at idle in Drive (mounts)

• Ask for valve adjustment / transmission fluid service records

Notes

$8,000 cash only, ~140k mi, automatic, clean title (per ad), backup camera, new tires. Found 2026-10-23.

HF = the high-fuel-economy Civic (aero wheels/underbody): EPA 29 city / 41 hwy / 33 combined - best highway MPG on the list.

Ad is keyword-stuffed and cash-only, so it may be a flipper: make sure the title is in the seller's name, get the VIN and run it, and pre-purchase inspect. Top of budget - try to negotiate.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.